

C721

Change Management

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A 300-bed hospital bought an electronic charting system from a vendor with a large market share. Managers set a go-live date and began training right away without explaining why paper charts had to go. Weeks later many nurses still say they see nothing wrong with paper, and some keep parallel paper charts. Using Lewin's model, which stage was skipped?

- A. Unfreezing
- B. None; the issue is choosing a vendor with less market share.
- C. Refreezing
- D. Changing (movement)

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A company has made the case for a new ordering process, trained everyone, and the process is working. What does Lewin's model call for next?

- A. Unfreeze again to prepare people for the change.
- B. Nothing; the change is complete once people are trained.
- C. Refreeze: build the new process into policies, measures and rewards.
- D. Start the next major change right away so the team never settles.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A new CEO, who previously led a turnaround at a credit union, wants to consolidate a regional bank's branches. Profits are steady and most employees believe things are fine. She has already drafted a vision statement. Using Kotter's model, what should she do first?

- A. Share hard data on falling branch traffic to create a sense of urgency.
- B. Form a guiding coalition of senior leaders.
- C. Copy the plan from her credit union turnaround.
- D. Communicate the vision statement to every employee.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A year into a customer-service overhaul, leaders celebrated early wins, declared success and disbanded the change team. Within months old habits returned. Which part of Kotter's model was neglected?

- A.** Every change fails without an outside consultant.
- B.** Generating short-term wins.
- C.** Creating a sense of urgency.
- D.** Building on gains and anchoring the new approach in the culture.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

Workers at the company's oldest warehouse, built in 1978, are resisting a new handheld scanning system. A rumor says the scan data will be used to cut jobs, but leadership has no such plan. The system was chosen after a six-month pilot. Which approach best fits this resistance?

- A.** Rerun the six-month pilot to confirm the system works.
- B.** Education and communication: explain openly how the data will and will not be used.
- C.** Offer a retention bonus in exchange for accepting the system.
- D.** Tell workers the system is mandatory and move on.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

At an off-site retreat, a manager lists the driving forces for moving to a shared-services model (cost savings, customer demand) and the restraining forces (fear of job loss, missing skills) on a whiteboard. According to force field analysis, what is usually the more effective way to move forward?

- A.** Change is impossible while any restraining force remains.
- B.** Wait until the two sets of forces are in balance.
- C.** Reduce the restraining forces, for example with job guarantees and skills training.
- D.** Add more driving forces, such as tighter deadlines.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A manager raised incentives and set tighter deadlines to speed a new process, and resistance grew instead of shrinking. What does force field analysis suggest went wrong?

- A.** Adding pressure raised counter-pressure; restraining forces were left untouched.
- B.** The incentives were too small and should be doubled.
- C.** The process should be dropped because resistance exists.
- D.** Restraining forces do not affect the outcome.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A consumer-products firm that won a design award last year moved to a team-based product strategy. Sales staff are still paid individual commissions based only on their own accounts, and cross-team collaboration has stalled. What is the best diagnosis?

- A.** The firm should focus on its award-winning designs.
- B.** The team-based strategy is wrong and should be dropped.
- C.** A misfit between the new team-based work and the individual reward system.
- D.** The sales staff lack talent and should be replaced.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A sales team of 25 attended a kickoff where the VP explained why the company is moving to a new CRM, and most can repeat the reasons. In interviews, many say they see no personal benefit and plan to keep their spreadsheets. The CRM license costs \$90 per user per month. Using ADKAR, where should the change effort focus next?

- A.** Knowledge: schedule hands-on CRM training.
- B.** Awareness: hold another kickoff explaining the business reasons.
- C.** Negotiate a lower license fee.
- D.** Desire: show each rep what the change does for them.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Nurses completed training on a new handoff checklist and used it well for a month. Nobody checked or recognized its use, and by month three most had stopped. Which ADKAR element was missing?

- A.** Awareness
- B.** Ability, because anyone who stops never truly learned.
- C.** Knowledge
- D.** Reinforcement

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A school district with 400 teachers and a newly hired superintendent is rolling out a new online grading tool. To spread use across the majority of teachers, which group should the district enlist first?

- A.** The few tech enthusiasts who try every new tool.
- B.** Respected early adopters whom other teachers already turn to for advice.
- C.** The new superintendent, by requiring every teacher to switch the same week.
- D.** The most resistant teachers, so everyone else follows.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A plant rolled out a new lockout safety procedure with strong training. Six months later, shortcuts are back. Supervisor bonuses are still based only on units shipped. The plant's safety manager is a former Navy officer. What will most help the change stick?

- A.** Well-trained people never slide back.
- B.** Add safety compliance to supervisor bonuses and daily metrics.
- C.** Put up more safety posters.
- D.** Run the training again.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A ~~300-bed~~ hospital bought an electronic charting system ~~from a vendor with a large market share~~. Managers set a go-live date and began training right away without explaining why paper charts had to go. Weeks later many nurses still say they see nothing wrong with paper, and some keep parallel paper charts. Using Lewin's model, which stage was skipped?

Target word: which stage was skipped **Decides:** Staff never accepted that the old way had to end.

A	Correct	No case was made for leaving the status quo, so people never let go of paper.
B	Camouflage	The vendor detail does not explain why staff reject the change.
C	Adjacent category	Refreezing locks in a change people have accepted; here they never accepted it.
D	Confusion set	The movement step, go-live and training, did happen.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A company has made the case for a new ordering process, trained everyone, and the process is working. What does Lewin's model call for next?

Target word: the step after the change is in place **Decides:** The change stage is complete; refreeze comes next.

A	Inverted operation	Runs the model backward; unfreezing already happened.
B	Dropped element	Drops the refreeze stage, which is why many changes fade.
C	Correct	Refreezing stabilizes the new state so it does not slip.
D	Adjacent category	Constant change prevents the new state from becoming stable.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A new CEO, ~~who previously led a turnaround at a credit union~~, wants to consolidate a regional bank's branches. Profits are steady and most employees believe things are fine. ~~She has already drafted a vision statement~~. Using Kotter's model, what should she do first?

Target word: first step in a complacent organization **Decides:** Employees see no problem; urgency is missing.

A	Correct	Kotter's first step is urgency, and complacency is the stated condition.
B	Adjacent category	A real step, but the second one; it does not take hold without urgency.
C	Camouflage	Her past success does not decide the first step here.
D	Inverted operation	Communicating the vision comes after urgency and a coalition exist.

4. Answer D Concept 2 • transfer

A year into a customer-service overhaul, leaders celebrated early wins, declared success and disbanded the change team. Within months old habits returned. Which part of Kotter's model was neglected?

Target word: which step failed, reasoning from the outcome **Decides:** Victory declared early; nothing anchored the change.

A	Absolute language	Nothing in the model requires consultants.
B	Confusion set	Short-term wins were achieved and celebrated.
C	Inverted operation	Urgency starts a change; the failure here happened at the end.
D	Correct	Steps 7 and 8 keep the change going after early wins.

5. Answer B Concept 3

Workers at the company's oldest warehouse, ~~built in 1978~~, are resisting a new handheld scanning system. A rumor says the scan data will be used to cut jobs, but leadership has no such plan. ~~The system was chosen after a six-month pilot.~~ Which approach best fits this resistance?

Target word: response matched to the source of resistance **Decides:** Resistance comes from inaccurate information.

A	Camouflage	The system's performance is not what workers are resisting.
B	Correct	Misinformation is best met with accurate information.
C	Adjacent category	Negotiation fits a real loss; here the loss is only rumored.
D	Confusion set	Coercion is a last resort and would feed the job-cut rumor.

6. Answer C Concept 4

~~At an off-site retreat,~~ a manager lists the driving forces for moving to a shared-services model (cost savings, customer demand) and the restraining forces (fear of job loss, missing skills) ~~on a whiteboard.~~ According to force field analysis, what is usually the more effective way to move forward?

Target word: which lever to pull **Decides:** Reducing restraints moves the balance with less counter-pressure.

A	Absolute language	Change needs a shift in balance, not zero resistance.
B	Confusion set	Balanced forces are the status quo; nothing moves.
C	Correct	Lowering resistance shifts the balance without building tension.
D	Inverted operation	Extra pressure tends to raise matching resistance.

7. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

A manager raised incentives and set tighter deadlines to speed a new process, and resistance grew instead of shrinking. What does force field analysis suggest went wrong?

Target word: explain the failure, reasoning backward **Decides:** Only driving forces were increased.

A	Correct	Pushing harder tends to raise tension rather than move the balance.
B	Inverted operation	Doubles down on the same lever that caused the pushback.
C	Absolute language	Some resistance is normal and can be reduced.
D	Dropped element	Drops half the model; outcomes depend on both sets of forces.

8. Answer C Concept 5

A consumer-products firm ~~that won a design award last year~~ moved to a team-based product strategy. Sales staff are still paid individual commissions based only on their own accounts, and cross-team collaboration has stalled. What is the best diagnosis?

Target word: root cause **Decides:** The reward system (formal structure) pulls against the new team-based work.

A	Camouflage	The award does not bear on why collaboration stalled.
B	Confusion set	Confuses a poor fit around the strategy with a poor strategy.
C	Correct	The pay design rewards the old behavior, so collaboration stalls.
D	Adjacent category	Blames the people when the system is pulling against them.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A sales team of 25 attended a kickoff where the VP explained why the company is moving to a new CRM, and most can repeat the reasons. In interviews, many say they see no personal benefit and plan to keep their spreadsheets. ~~The CRM license costs \$90 per user per month.~~ Using ADKAR, where should the change effort focus next?

Target word: first missing ADKAR element **Decides:** Awareness is present; desire is missing.

A	Adjacent category	Training people who do not want the change skips a step.
B	Confusion set	They already understand the reasons.
C	Camouflage	Cost does not decide which ADKAR element is missing.
D	Correct	Awareness exists; desire is the first element that fails.

10. Answer D Concept 6 • transfer

Nurses completed training on a new handoff checklist and used it well for a month. Nobody checked or recognized its use, and by month three most had stopped. Which ADKAR element was missing?

Target word: missing element, reasoning from the outcome **Decides:** They could do it but nothing sustained it.

A	Inverted operation	The first element; the breakdown happened at the end.
B	Absolute language	A month of correct use shows ability; stopping points to reinforcement.
C	Confusion set	They were trained and used the checklist correctly.
D	Correct	Ability was shown; without reinforcement the behavior faded.

11. Answer B Concept 7

A school district ~~with 400 teachers and a newly hired superintendent~~ is rolling out a new online grading tool. To spread use across the majority of teachers, which group should the district enlist first?

Target word: whom to enlist first **Decides:** The majority imitates respected early adopters.

A	Confusion set	Innovators are often seen as outliers, so others do not copy them.
B	Correct	Early adopters are opinion leaders; the majority follows them.
C	Camouflage	The new superintendent is a detail; a mandate is not a diffusion strategy.
D	Inverted operation	Laggards adopt last and rarely influence the majority.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A plant rolled out a new lockout safety procedure with strong training. Six months later, shortcuts are back. Supervisor bonuses are still based only on units shipped. ~~The plant's safety manager is a former Navy officer.~~ What will most help the change stick?

Target word: sustaining lever **Decides:** The bonus system rewards speed over the new procedure.

A	Absolute language	Backsliding is common when systems reward the old behavior.
B	Correct	Aligning rewards and measures with the new behavior sustains it.
C	Dropped element	Messaging alone leaves out the system that is driving the shortcuts.
D	Adjacent category	People already know the procedure; the incentives pull against it.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Lewin's three stages	Unfreeze (make the case that the status quo must go), change (move to the new way), refreeze (lock it in with structure and reinforcement).	Starting with implementation, or stopping once people are trained.	People never accepted the need, or backslid after launch.
2	Kotter's eight steps, in order	Urgency, guiding coalition, vision, communicate, remove obstacles, short-term wins, build on gains, anchor in culture.	Jumping to the vision or declaring victory after early wins.	A complacent organization, or a change that fades after early success.
3	Matching the response to the source of resistance	Misinformation calls for education; lack of ownership calls for participation; real losses call for negotiation; coercion is a last resort.	Using one tactic, usually pressure, for every kind of resistance.	The stem says why people resist: a rumor, a real loss, or being left out.
4	Force field analysis	Change moves the balance between driving and restraining forces; reducing restraining forces usually works better than adding pressure.	Pushing harder with more driving forces.	Two lists of forces for and against a change.
5	Diagnosing fit before prescribing	Performance problems usually come from misfit among the work, people, formal structure and culture; diagnose the gap before picking a fix.	Blaming people or the strategy when systems are pulling against each other.	A new strategy running under old structures, rewards or processes.
6	ADKAR for individual change	Awareness, desire, knowledge, ability, reinforcement, in order; fix the first element that is missing.	Training (knowledge) people who do not yet want the change.	People understand why but say "what's in it for me?", or can do it but stop.
7	Diffusion of innovations	Spread a new practice through respected early adopters, whom the majority watches and imitates.	Starting with innovators seen as outliers, or with the most resistant laggards.	A rollout across a large group and a question about whom to enlist first.
8	Sustaining change through aligned systems	Change lasts when rewards, measures and routines reinforce the new behavior.	Thinking more training or messaging will stop backsliding.	People slip back while incentives still reward the old way.

Course scope (public description): Change Management provides an understanding of change and an overview of successfully managing change using various methods and tools. Emphasizing change theories and various best practices, this course covers how to recognize and implement change using an array of other effective strategies, including those related to innovation and leadership. Other topics include approaches to change, diagnosing and planning for change, implementing change, and sustaining change.